The Parishioner

Sunday 11-October-2026



Twenty Eighth Sunday In Ordinary Time
Prisioner's Sunday
od promised his people a future of great blessings where death and mourning would be no more. Christ came to issue God's *final invitation to this future. Some rejected it, others accepted it but then made light of it. What have we done with our invitation?*



The Family of Parishes of: Ballincollig | Ballinora | Kilmurry | Ovens and Farran

Vocations for The Diocese of Cork

Last weekend, we had the visit of the Director of Vocations to the parish of Ballincollig. Father Marius O'Reilly was appointed a few weeks ago to this role in a full-time capacity. Part of his ministry initially will be to visit the sixty-eight parishes across the diocese of Cork and Ross. So, I'm sure he'll make it to the folks in Ballinora, Ovens, and Kilmurry in the coming months also. Beyond telling us a little about his own vocation story and narrating the appointments he's held since being ordained, Marius also reached out for people to form a monthly prayer meeting specifically for vocations to the priesthood in the diocese of Cork and Ross. Some 56 people signed up in Ballincollig, which I think is quite encouraging. The Church does need some of its members to serve communities as ordained priests and praying for this is worthwhile, not least because it reminds us to be open to God's will in our lives.

That said, though, I do wonder about the bigger picture. If a lack of vocations were down to a lack of prayer, then the issue would never have arisen: each and every day people tell me that they pray for their priests and for vocations. So, a reasonable person would naturally be led to ask if the Holy Spirit is prompting us to change how we are as a Church. And while no one person can speak definitively for the Spirit, the 'sensus fidelium' ['the shared sense of the faithful'] is worth paying heed to. I know myself that hardly a week goes by without someone asking me about the potential role of married men and women. These are legitimate questions to ask, even if a convincing answer comes frustratingly slowly.

In the meantime, it might be good to ask ourselves what role I can exercise in my local parish: what gifts do I have to share? There is ever and always a need for additional voices to read, more hands to minister Holy Communion, new minds to share vision at the Parish Pastoral Council. All that's asked is that we be open to God's will in our lives – both in what's necessary now, and what's possible in the future.

God bless.

Ronan Sheehan CC

Abide in His Love Women's Conference

Abide Women's Conference, November 20-22, the Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Domincans & more, Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. We would love to welcome you this weekend. For more details please visit Abide in His Love at eventbrite.ie Registration link: https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com

Irish National Synodal Assembly

The Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, taking place in Gormanston, Co Meath, on 17 October, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland. While the Assembly marks an important moment in the journey, the Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the Working Document and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?" Please pray for all those taking part in the Assembly and for the guidance of the Holy Spirit. To find out more, see www.synod.ie

October - The Month of the Holy Rosary

"Pope Leo has asked us to pray the Rosary for Peace during the Month of October" (CNS/Vatican Media). St. Mary's & St. John's Church Ballincollig 7-8 PM. All are invited to join in prayer for peace just for a short while, or for one Rosary or for the Hour of Prayer.

7:00: Joyful Mysteries - Silence
7:15: Sorrowful Mysteries - Silence
7:30: Glorious Mysteries - Silence
7:45 Mysteries of Light

It is giving people an opportunity to join for whatever time you can manage, or bring your children for a short time.

Notification of second collection at all Masses for dates specified below

Diocesan needs 10th / 1th October, Propagation of the Faith 17th / 18th October Diocesan Youth Ministry 14th/ 15th November

Applies to all churches in Family of Parishes

In the Lord's own house shall I dwell for ever and ever.

Ballincollig Parish Number for Priest on Duty is: 087 4021357
For Parish office Telephone is 089 4008181 Mon - Wed. 9.00am - 12.30pm

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